

technology problems: they're stuck and need a solution quickly. They visit well-known technology forums, register, post their question and then wait a while. Once they have their answer, they're gone before you can say *Digit!*

There's nothing really wrong with being a one-time visitor, and one can't blame people for trying to find solutions to their problems. However, netiquette demands that users check back on their questions a few days later and see if there are any replies. Even if you didn't find the answer to your question at a forum, and found it elsewhere instead, return to all the places you posted the question at and give those people the answer. This at least enriches other forums with the right answers.

Occasional Browsers

These are generally users who are not particularly interested in a forum, but like to come back to see if there's anything interesting happening. The reason for their infrequent visits might be lack of time. However, there are two very distinct personalities of people who fit into this category—those who come to learn a few tips now and then, and those who come to impart knowledge when they're bored.

At the *Digit* forum, this group comprises less than five per cent of the overall member population. The reason is simple: because we are a monthly, almost all the members have something new to talk about each month. This breathes fresh life into every regular contributor's typing fingers—whether it's to criticise or praise is not important.

At *Digit's* forum, most members fall into one of the other categories: they either don't care and are one-timers, or are hooked and come back at least a few times a month.

Regular Contributors

These members are the mainstay of any successful forum, and visit and contribute at least a few times a week. They have a genuine interest in the topics discussed on the forum, and enjoy the company of their peers.